

KF18 Expanded Version of Teachings

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Try me and know my anxious thoughts. See if there is any hurtful way in me, and lead me in everlasting ways.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

0:02 PRESENTING

0:06 KARIS CIRCULATION

0:07 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

0:08 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

This week we are focusing on KF Confession 4:

We judged ourselves and others with contempt and felt justified in our wrath.

Any effort we make to train in meditation and mindfulness is worthwhile. We learn to endure the discomforts and struggle of learning a new skill. Through practice, we develop the courage to maintain a consistent direction, and we strengthen our ability to focus. Meditation supports our overall health by training our minds to abide in the present moment with the balanced and creative perspective of non-judgment. We learn to stop wasting our energy on illusions and limitless impossibilities; instead, we invest our gifts in the immediate and the real.

At this point in your training, you may wish to print off the four exercises that you have been learning and practice each one for five minutes. You might adopt this as a daily plan, giving you twenty minutes of mindfulness and meditation practice. If you have little ones to care for, take short breaks throughout the day to meditate.

- For five minutes, make a list of what bothers you today and tell God about it. Then, practice the **3-Minute Breathing Space**.¹
- For five minutes, practice the **Maranatha Meditation**.²
- For five minutes, practice the **SALT Process**. You might choose to work on an item from the list of what is bothering you today.
- For five minutes, practice the **Mercy Meditation** focusing on either yourself or others.³

Just explore. Your purpose is to find a meditation practice that works for you. In this lesson, we will use the **Mercy Meditation** to extend mercy to another person. Let's begin.

Settle into your environment and observe your breathing. (*Pause for 10 seconds*) Notice how your body softens on the exhale. (*Pause*) Scan your body for tension and give any tense areas permission to relax. Notice especially your face. Is there tension there? Relax. (*Pause for 30 seconds*)

Draw your mind away from the events of the day, from the past or the future, and from others, and focus on what is happening inside your own skin right now. *(Pause for 10 seconds)* Allow a person to come to mind to whom you wish to extend mercy, or you might wish to consider a situation in which you find it difficult to extend mercy to someone. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

And now, as you think about that person, reflect for thirty seconds on each of the following questions. You might jot down the thoughts you wish to remember.

1. In what areas am I most critical of this person? (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)

Pause. If you haven't done so already, take thirty seconds to jot down what came to mind. You might write in your KF journal or on your **Meeting Preparation Guide**. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

2. For what do I need to forgive this person? (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)

Pause. Take a moment to jot down what came to mind. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

3. How do I treat this person when they make a mistake or do not live up to my standards? (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)

Pause, and write for thirty seconds. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Now, use your imagination in a healthy way to experiment with bringing compassion to this person. You might call to mind someone who loves this person as they are. This might be someone divine, like God or Jesus, or perhaps someone mortal and human. You might call to mind one of God's other creatures. *(Pause)* As you breathe for one minute, observe whatever comes to mind and practice letting go of judgment. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause, take a deep breath, and re-engage with the meeting.

You will learn more about mercy in later lessons, but right now you are learning to let go of fear and judgment. This is a way of planting seeds of mercy, not only for others but also for yourself.

Our hymn of mercy is *When I Survey the Wondrous Cross*.

Were the whole realm of nature mine,
That were an offering far too small;
Love so amazing, so divine,
Demands my soul, my life, my all.⁴

Actually, there is no demand in karis; there is simply an invitation to generously respond to God's gift of salvation so that we may experience more and more of His amazing love.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this training?")

0:20 KARIS CONFESSION

0:21 TOOLBOX

Sometimes it hurts our pride to be reminded of KF Confession 4:

We judged ourselves and others with contempt and felt justified in our wrath.

In this lesson we will explore the **Claim and Blame Worksheet**. This worksheet is designed to help you identify and untangle your claims about what you think you deserve from others and from life. It is similar to the **Shoulds Worksheet**, which for simplicity we also call the **Shoulds Sheet**. I hope that your practice with the **Shoulds Sheet** will make using the **Claim and Blame Worksheet** easier. You might ask your Karis Link to explore it with you, and you can also sign up for other KF training opportunities.

Let's look briefly at the **Claim and Blame Worksheet** now.

Part One: You Are Here

1. Indicators and reactions

What feelings or reactions have let you know that you are misoriented? Your KF training begins with mindfulness because without this skill you cannot be aware of how you are feeling or notice how you are reacting, nor can you spot the events that trigger your feelings and reactions. In the past, you may have believed your reactions to be acceptable and justified, or perhaps they were so habitual that you didn't notice that your pride was hurt or that you had slipped into judgment and fear.

2. Identify your feelings

This worksheet includes a list of feelings that may be associated with your claim. The list is slightly different from the one on the **Shoulds Sheet**, although both lists deal with feelings that may arise from hurt pride. The **Shoulds Sheet** deals with feelings that are the result of self-hate, whereas the **Claim and Blame Worksheet** deals with feelings that arise when an event seems unfair and does not endorse your self-attributed entitlements, when you can't get away with something, when consequences do not support your self-evaluation, and when you are envious of what others do or have. You might recognize other feelings that are not on the list. Feel free to jot those down, too.

3. When and what?

Try to determine the event that invited you to take the Judgment Path. You can ask yourself: *When did I start feeling this way? Was there an event that I judged as bad or not good enough? What was that event?*

4. Restoring pride

Your sense of fairness or justice often masks hurt pride. What do you imagine would soothe your pride, satisfy your sense of justice, and fix your feelings? You may want to punish others who have violated your claim; and when you discover that you were not wonderful or spectacular enough to be treated with particular regard or to be exempt from consequences, you may feel the need to punish yourself with sabotaging behavior or thoughts.

Part Two: Looking Deeply

1. It's not fair!

Now you can use your imagination to go to an extreme of what you think would be fair. Why is this situation unfair and how does it threaten the *Glory of Me!*?

2. I deserve

You learned from Dr. Horney's book that you are averse to recognizing your own claims because you

need these illusions to maintain your pride system. You may, therefore, find it difficult to identify your claims unless you feel frustrated, cheated, hurt, or compelled to retaliate. Keep in mind that judging as unfair what happens to others may reveal a claim that you have for yourself. You might think of this as an externalized claim. Write down what you believe you deserve in the situation—that is, in your situation, to what do you feel entitled?

3. My right to react

Now that you have defined what you think you deserve in the situation, you can identify the behaviors and choices that you use to redress the violation of your claim. When your claims are not met, what reactions do you feel you have a right to indulge? These reactions often seem rational, just, or understandable to us in the moment, but they are actually powered by judgment, hurt pride, and fear.

Doing a **Claim and Blame Worksheet** might feel like hard work, but it is easier to deal with a claim the moment you recognize it than to deal with the fallout of your misoriented reactions.

4. My perfect life

This question helps you define your claim. You get to laugh at yourself a little and explore the imagined superiority of your wisdom and judgments. You also have the chance to be extravagantly and ludicrously honest with yourself.

Part 3: Recovery

1. Assess the judgment

Recall the **Two Paths Flowchart**. If you have judged an event as evil, you have probably felt fear. This is where you explore the fear and the evils that you imagined when your claim was not met. If your claim was met, you may have felt euphoria and judged the event as good. Perhaps by now you can see how your judgments are very partial, unrealistic, and unjust when they are based on a claim.

2. Identify the fear of loss

You have reacted because something has made mincemeat of your search for the *Glory of Me!*, and, as a result, you are gripped by fear, grief, and rage. You are now in a position to explore your fear of loss. If you have reviewed the chapter on your Idol type and made a list of your hotspots, you may find it easier to identify the hotspot that was triggered by the event.

3. Stick to the facts

Next, you take the Believe it Path and simply list the sequence of events. This is where you get real. You give up your judgments, detach from your feelings, and just look at the facts. As your True Self grows, you will become more interested in the truth than in your neurotic entitlements and compelling illusions which help you feel superior and protect your pride.

4. Make a decision

Perhaps at this point you are ready to let go of your judgments and are willing to deal with how things actually are. If you are not ready, pray this prayer anyway. Ask God to help loosen the hold that your pride and the claims of your pride have on you. You may need to do one of the self-healing interventions listed in step 7 and then return to this step.

5. Rejoice in the truth

You have cleared away the illusions about what you deserve, and you are now willing to look in the

mirror at the truth about yourself. Only the truth will set you free. As long as you continue to play with the pretend toys of your illusions, you will not learn the mature skills that you need for handling reality and building healthy relationships. Only the truth can set you free to live in humility and access the gifts of God's grace.

6. Take action: talk to God

This prayer of confession helps you focus on the real issue of your choices. You have been trying to save the life of your Idol and fulfill its dreams of glory, and you have seen the depths of your pride. The Bible tells us that God gives grace only to the humble; He extends an invitation of fellowship to the one who confesses the truth and is ready to make the effort to grow out of egocentric cravings. Pride is so destructive. It is the toxin that stunts your growth and hinders the lives of those around you. God must oppose your pride. He cannot support illusions and fantasies. He is true, and He is working to bring you into truth.

I hope that you will use this **Claim and Blame Worksheet** in your training program. The more you use it, the more quickly you will recognize your claims. You will learn to let go of your claims and with them the longing to restore your hurt pride. You will stop allowing your claims to waste your energy, restrict your opportunities, and undermine your efforts toward developing real self-confidence.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Lord, loosen the grip of pride on my soul. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?")

0:30 SHARING

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

KF Confession 4 reminds us of how we waste our energy in the service of the Idol. Let's hear it again:

We judged ourselves and others with contempt and felt justified in our wrath.

Jesus often encourages us to think through what we want, and in the Gospel of Matthew, chapter 5, He teaches us to be motivated by our wants rather than driven by the law of our shoulds.⁵ We can stop wasting our energy thinking, "I should do that," and, instead, use our energy to ask, "What outcome do I want, and how do I get it?" As you read the passage for this Bible teaching, I would like you to keep in mind that when writing an English translation, translators cannot include every English word that could accurately replace a Greek word. I have used the English word *happy* to help us understand the meaning of the Greek word *makarioi*, but I could equally use the words *favored* or even *lucky*. Although these two words are not commonly used in translations of this passage, they more accurately convey the meaning of the original Greek.

The text for our lesson is **Matthew 5:3–10**. Let's listen to my translation of this well-known passage.

³Happy (favored) are beggars in spirit who are continually pleading and crying out for spiritual connection, because the kingdom of heaven is theirs.

⁴Happy (favored) are those who truly mourn, because they are the ones who shall be comforted by someone who is called alongside to help.

⁵Happy (favored) are the mild and gentle, for they shall inherit the earth.

⁶Happy (favored) are those who hunger and thirst for orientation, because they are the ones that shall be satisfied like grazing herds in a spring meadow.

⁷Happy (favored) are the compassionate and merciful, for they are the ones who shall receive help, compassion, and mercy.

⁸Happy (favored) are the single-minded, pruned, purified by fire, and free from guilty, craving hearts, because they are the ones who shall see God.

⁹Happy (favored) are those who generate peace for they shall be called the sons of God and carry the authority of His name.

¹⁰Happy (favored) are those who have been persecuted for the sake of orientation, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

Take a deep breath.

Jesus tells us how to be happy, blessed, and favored. He also exposes the lies we tell ourselves about what would make us happy. He invites us to build a happy life by developing oriented qualities and choosing oriented behaviors. Unfortunately, oriented behaviors are difficult to learn when we are caught in the grip of the Idol's pride system. It is much easier to claim to possess Christian qualities than it is to grow them in our lives.

In an attempt to maintain my pride system and ward off self-hate, I might claim spiritual qualities that I don't actually have. Then, when my unhealthy behavior reveals my lack of strength, immaturity or untrustworthiness, I have to ignore all that evidence in order to maintain the illusion that I am strong, mature, and trustworthy. It's much easier to lie to myself than to face the truth. My reaction to having the illusion of my claims exposed will be in proportion to my fear of shame and hurt pride. If I am to continue to believe my own lies, I will have to gradually harden myself to the evidence of the truth and lead myself more deeply into self-delusion and moral decay.

Jesus says that if we want to know real, abiding happiness and experience the karis favor of God, we must recognize the poverty of our own Idol's system and choose another kind of poverty—we must become beggars in the spirit. Beggars learn quickly what works and what doesn't work. They are highly motivated to get their needs met and don't waste their energy gratifying their pride. As a beggar, I use my words and plead to God for spiritual authority. I then adopt an open attitude and seek ways to learn. I do not judge as evil the door of training that is set before me; rather, I take action by knocking on that door.

No beggar comes to a time when he can stop begging. The hunger and thirst that he feels today he will feel tomorrow. The beggar keeps begging until he dies. In KF, we learn to keep begging every day for the needs of our soul to be met and for an ever-expanding spiritual connection with God—and as long as we are training here in this material world, we will need to keep begging.

Look at the list of beatitudes in Matthew 5. Each line begins with the word *happy*, or *favored*. Do you want to be happy and favored? Perhaps you have a claim that you deserve happiness because you have certain beliefs. You might envy the apparent happiness of others and yet ignore the ways in which you are making yourself unhappy. Do you know that it is within your power to be happy, favored, and blessed? Look at the causes of happiness at the end of the sentences in our text. We are happy because we have spiritual authority, because we are comforted, because we are satisfied, because we can see God. In order to

produce the effect of being happy, Jesus says that you must develop certain qualities and make certain choices. These qualities and choices are the cause that produces the effect of your happiness. For example, if you want spiritual authority, you must choose to be a beggar in the spirit, and if you want to see God working in your life, you must become single-minded. The unwillingness to develop these qualities and make these choices is what interferes with your happiness and well-being. You might believe that you will be happy if you do what Jesus tells you to do, but believing is not the same as doing. You have to trust God enough to do what Jesus tells you to do. You may be unhappy because you do not trust God.

What do you really want?

Trying to motivate yourself by what you think you should do will not help you productively endure in every situation or in the long run. If you want to achieve your desired outcomes, you will need to learn to motivate yourself by what you really want. Look at verse 7. Jesus tells us that those who practice mercy will receive mercy, so rather than thinking, “I should be merciful,” think about whether you want to receive mercy. If you really want to receive mercy, you will be motivated to practice mercy. Now look at verse 6. Rather than thinking, “I should hunger and thirst for orientation, and I hate myself because I am not doing that,” you might realize that what you really want is to be satisfied. How do you become satisfied? Jesus tells you how. Refuse to prop up your pride system. Learn to keep asking, seeking, and knocking for orientation—just as a hungry person asks, seeks, and knocks for food—and you will become satisfied. Satisfaction, like achieving three square meals a day, is the result of your effort.

We might compare the motivation of shoulds with the motivation of real wanting. Listen to the following statements and use your mindfulness training to observe your emotional reactions:

- I should be a beggar in the spirit.
- I should hunger and thirst for orientation.
- I should be gentle.
- I should be a peacemaker.

How does that feel? *(Pause for 5 seconds)*

Now, observe your emotions when you hear the following statements:

- I want spiritual authority.
- I want to be satisfied and fulfilled.
- I want to inherit the earth.
- I want peace within and around me.

(Pause for 5 seconds)

Does this second list of statements feel less tense, more single-minded, and more congruent—more like the voice of your True Self? Does your body feel less strain? *(Pause for 5 seconds)*

So, what is preventing you from accessing God’s provision of happiness or well-being? This might seem a little crazy, but there are days and even years when we do not want to have spiritual authority, receive mercy, be at peace, or be satisfied. We sometimes hate aspects of ourselves so much or are so totally

committed to running our own lives that we are more comfortable with the suffering and wastefulness of misorientation than we are with the prospect of exploring a world of love, joy, and peace—a world that we have only heard about. The problem is that a big part of us does not want to be well. Our pride stands in the way. But the good news is that we can allow ourselves to be messed up in our feelings and still choose life. No matter what you feel, choose life.⁶ As you taste real life and its outcomes, you will discover how worthwhile it is to keep choosing life.

Let's look at the truth about ourselves. Again, I am so sorry to tell you this, but only the truth will set you free.⁷ If we do not have spiritual authority in this material world, then we are not begging for spiritual connection, or orientation. We are probably begging for something else. We may claim that we hunger and thirst for orientation, but our lack of satisfaction is evidence that our claim has no substance. If we do not have comfort, then we are not mourning for the right reasons. We may, instead, be mourning the damage to our pride and our failure to get our own way. If we are not experiencing compassion or mercy from God or others, then we are not being compassionate toward others, or toward ourselves. If we are not seeing glimpses of God, then we could use some pruning and purifying by fire. If we are not at peace within ourselves, it will show up in our choices, circumstances, and relationships. This is the scary part—and it is scary: You really are responsible for your own life. You really do have control of your own happiness.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Lord, I am willing to be happy. Show me how to get there. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?")

1:10 INTEGRATION

Sip some purified water and prepare to take some notes. Assume a mindfulness posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider the power to choose the outcomes of your own life. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

The FAITH Process

(Choose from each section a few phrases that are meaningful to you)

Feelings

As you *consider the power to choose the outcomes of your own life*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. You can learn to recognize and honor your feelings without allowing them to master you. *(Pause)* Recognize with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Awareness without judgment

Allow your experience to rest in your awareness as you *consider the power to choose the outcomes of your own life*. You might notice a compulsion to argue with yourself or with God, to judge yourself and others, or to make up stories. We often flush thoughts or feelings from our awareness before they have a chance to teach us. Observe whatever tension you may be feeling. *(Pause)* Feelings and passing thoughts

are not right or wrong; they just are. Give yourself permission now to explore them without judgment, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Bring your attention to your body and notice what it is doing as you *consider the power to choose the outcomes of your own life*. What sensations are there? *(Pause)* Your body is always talking to you. You may not understand its language right now, but you can observe. For example, you might recognize what doubt, panic, or hope feels like in your body. *(Pause)* If your sensations are uncomfortable, you can move your attention to an area of your body that is not reacting, and rest. When you are ready, return to respectfully observe those uncomfortable sensations. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider your power to choose the outcomes of your own life*. Does that feel comfortable, uncomfortable, or are you shutting down? Just observe. *(Pause)* What do you believe about your power? *(Pause)* How might your Idol's pride be hurt if you accepted this power to choose? *(Pause)* It's OK if you don't know. Just observe how you respond, and breathe with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Heal

You might imagine a door of opportunity opening before you. As you breathe, repeat the word *Welcome*. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

(Pause for 8 seconds or one long breath after each statement)

- Welcome this opportunity to explore your power to choose.
- Welcome the Holy Spirit of truth as He teaches you about your design and authority.
- Welcome the progress you have made.
- Welcome what you are learning about yourself. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Now, as you breathe, you might use the following statements as a confession to the Lord and turn away from the Idol Self. On the exhale, let go.⁸

(Pause for 5 seconds after each statement)

- As I develop my power to choose, I let go of the longing for, or the fear of, responsibility and self-determination.
- As I develop my power to choose, I let go of the longing for, or the fear of, appreciation and affection.
- As I develop my power to choose, I let go of the longing for, or the fear of, security and comfort.
- As I develop my power to choose, I let go of the fear of changing my outcomes and becoming happy. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are grateful for this time together to heal and to train. Hold us in the power of this redirected energy

as You guide us to our real glory. Show us the next step in our healing this week. We want to co-labor with You so that we can access all of Your karis gifts in this life and the next, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?”)

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

¹ Zindel Segal, J. Mark G Williams and John D Teasdale, *Mindfulness-Based Cognitive Therapy for Depression* (New York: The Guilford Press, 2013), 208. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

² Laurence Freeman, Editor, *Monastery without Walls: The Spiritual Letters of John Main* (London: Canterbury Press Norwich, 2006), 32.

³ www.livingmindfully.org. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

⁴ *When I Survey the Wondrous Cross* by Isaac Watts (1674–1748), youtu.be/U-hz6L6LAug.

⁵ Mark 10:51.

⁶ Deut. 30:19.

⁷ John 8:32.

⁸ www.camillecaldwell.com/WelcomePrayer.html. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.